

PwC Cybersecurity & Controls Virtual Internship – Case Study Portfolio

A professionally formatted summary of project tasks, analyses, and reflections completed during the PwC Cybersecurity Virtual Internship.

Introduction

This document summarizes my work from the PwC Cybersecurity & Controls Virtual Internship. For each task, I reviewed the scenario, provided my response, compared it with PwC's exemplar, and reflected on key learnings. To respect PwC's intellectual property, scenarios and exemplars are summarized in my own words, with focus on my analysis and professional development.

Task 1 – Procure-to-Pay (P2P) Process & SOX Controls

MedTech Industries is preparing for an IPO and must align processes with SOX requirements. My task was to analyze the P2P SOP, identify process and control gaps, and communicate risks and recommendations to the senior associate.

Task 1 – My Response

I identified segregation of duties concerns, weak access controls, shared credentials, informal access provisioning, and missing cash disbursement controls. Recommendations included unique credentials, formal access request processes, dual-signature validation, and strengthened oversight.

Task 1 – Exemplar Summary

PwC highlighted risks including: lack of supplier due diligence, missing purchase/payment validation, lack of cash reconciliation, and insufficient segregation of duties. It mapped gaps to risks and provided clear follow-up questions.

Task 1 – Reflection

I correctly identified several risks but my response was not organized by risk categories. PwC's structure was clearer and more concise. I plan to improve by explicitly connecting gaps to risks.

Task 2 – SDLC Walkthrough

I compared MedTech's SDLC SOP to NIST standards and participated in a walkthrough with the IT manager. I focused on functional/security testing, design reviews, and configuration management. I identified missing documentation and gaps in adherence.

Task 2 – Reflection

I noted missing design reviews and undocumented configuration management. I learned how to structure walkthrough questions and map SOPs to standards systematically.

Task 3 – Change Management Controls

I documented Tests of Design and Operating Effectiveness for emergency change approvals and segregation of duties. I correctly flagged the SoD conflict but missed the exception in emergency change approvals.

Task 3 – Reflection

I learned the importance of comparing expected control behavior to actual evidence and explicitly stating whether a control passes or fails.

Task 4 – Summary of Findings

Key findings included: lack of three-way match, segregation of duties failures, weak access controls, missing design reviews in SDLC, undocumented configuration management, and two CorpLaw exceptions.

Lessons Learned

- How to analyze processes and identify missing controls.
- How to assess risk and connect gaps to impacts.
- Importance of segregation of duties.
- Importance of regular access and process reviews.
- How to structure walkthroughs effectively.
- How to refine communication using professional exemplars.